economy, rejuvenated the private sector and made the economy grow at one of the highest rates globally for about twenty-five years.

Earlier, Lal Bahadur Shastri initiated fundamental reforms in agriculture by ushering in the green revolution, institutionalizing the Minimum Support Price (MSP) regime and establishing a grain purchase and storage system that helped India overcome its persistent food shortage problem and made it food-sufficient and self-reliant.

Evidently, strong leaders do not necessarily make sound economic policy decisions. And when poor economic policy choices get implemented on account of the stature and strength of these mass leaders, the risk to growth becomes even greater.

The Government is a Poor Entrepreneur and Businessman

Production and distribution of private goods (all goods except classic public or common goods like defence, internal security, currency, some type of infrastructure, macroeconomic stability, etc.) require business acumen, risking of capital for higher returns and flexibility of operations. These qualities are essential for efficient production and distribution of private goods, maximization of value addition at the lowest cost, faster adoption of technology for better quality and competitive cost, and vesting decision-making in managers to take on-the-spot decisions.

The government is not designed to have these abilities. Government managers are selected as generalists, not best suited for technical operations of any enterprise. Government processes are based on layers of decision-makers who are expected to take calls in a manner where the integrity of process, rather than the commercial value of the decision, is more important. The system of incentives and disincentives is differently designed for civil servants who can run excellent public services, but are grossly ill-equipped for operations of business entities.